

Why do people say that AI uses water?

Posted by u/BeginningMiddle7133 • 0 points • 236 comments

People say AI uses water for cooling and stuff, but doesn't the water just evaporate after it's done its job? I don't get it

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-02-11 15:15 UTC

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u/poophroughmyveins • 1 points • 2026-02-10 12:44 UTC

Some water evaporates, what doesn't evaporate are the trace minerals and toxins in the water that slowly increase in concentration before the self obsessed slop ghouls pour it right back into your water supply

u/Dibblerius • 1 points • 2026-02-09 23:57 UTC

That's true of anything that uses water.

The problem isn't that water runs out and disappears. It's that flow cycles are disturbed and that water is redirected from places in the environment where it might be needed.

Say you are redirecting water onto a cropfield for example. That means you're drying out other places where it would have flown. Do that at enough scale you might cause damage to nearby areas. Sure the water eventually comes back but its just directed away again.

u/smanjot • 1 points • 2026-02-09 19:34 UTC

You can't just use any "Water" to cool data centers. The water has to be treated so it is the right quality to actually use for cooling. The water also is used in generating the electricity needed to run the data center.

One can create a small town with the same amount of power and water but instead people want wrong answers quickly

u/kanji_kanji • 1 points • 2026-02-09 15:08 UTC

Data centers generate heat and need to be cooled. The simplest way is to cool them with water.

However, the underlying problem is that when this water comes into contact with heat sinks, it could become contaminated by metal residues and cannot be freely discharged into the environment.

AI data centers clearly don't use much more water than those typically used by other online services, but they do so much more consistently over time.

u/Ok_Top284 • 1 points • 2026-02-09 06:00 UTC

Don't quote me on this because I'm not an expert but I'm 88% certain the water is polluted during the cooling process and remains polluted even after going through the water cycle again.

u/Few_Example9391 • 1 points • 2026-02-09 04:41 UTC

Some of the most modern Nvidia AI server units do use water. It's no different than water cooled high-end gaming PCs or your car's engine. The only difference is. They are cooling tens of thousands of such servers in a giant server farm warehouse. Because of that, they use giant industrial scale water circulation systems feeding into large banks of evaporative water cooler mini towers. The idea here is to increase cooling efficiency and reduce energy costs of running a server farm